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D.Y. CHANDRACHUD, 63

CHIEF JUSTICE OF INDIA

defending democratic norms and protecting the independence of the judiciary—by stipulating the norms for the appointment of election commissioners, disclosing the Union government's reasons behind not approving the appointment of a judge, declaring politically motivated promotion of a judge as illegal and reprimanding the ban of a film by a state

BECAUSE he'll be one of the longest-serving CJIs in recent years, serving up to November 2024. His opinion will be key in the appointment of nearly 10 SC judges and in the shape of constitutional benches. In the past six months, CJI-led benches have decided the legality of the Maharashtra government and the distribution of power between the Centre and the Delhi government

EARLY RISER The Justice is up before sunrise, often at 3.30 am

RADIO STAR While his mother sang for All India Radio, Justice Chandrachud also worked as a radio jockey at AIR in his early 20s, hosting popular programmes such as 'Play It Cool', 'Date with You' and 'Sunday Request'